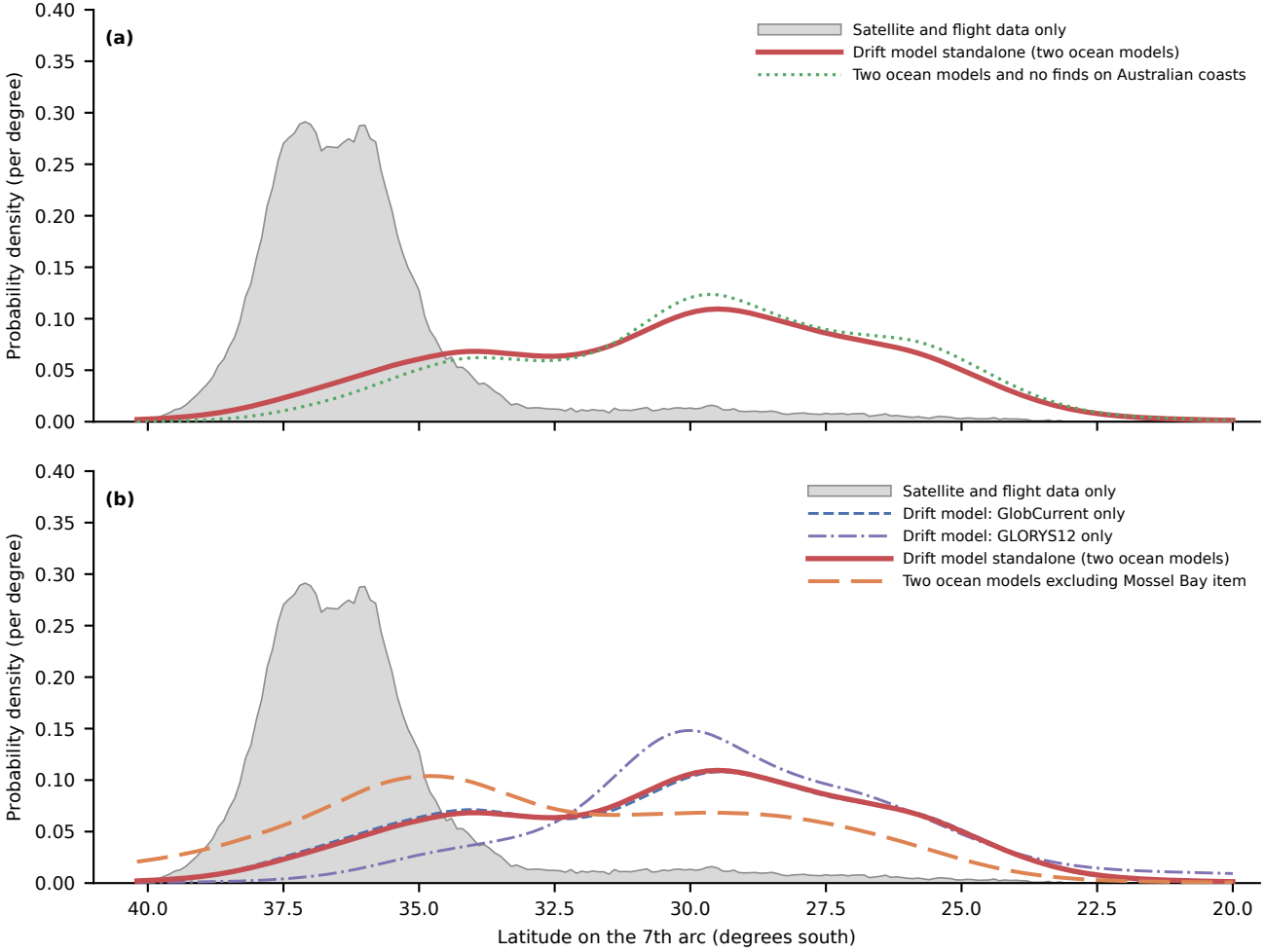
Drift model alone favours about 30 degrees south; satellite and flight data about 36




Notes. Drift: GLORYS12V1 currents at 0.494 m with ERA5 wind; Copernicus GlobCurrent with ERA5 wind, wind factor reduced for built-in wind drift; 84 release points from 40.25 to 19.92 S; finds scored to 30 Jan 2017; Mossel Bay dated at its first beaching (23 Dec 2015); detection levels log-normal (sigma 1) per coast and period, prior median 0.1 before 29 Jul 2015, 0.5 to 1 Mar 2016, then 1 (provisional); 262144 level draws; 16 ocean samples (32 south of 33.25 S); items weighted by identification grade (1 / 0.98 / 0.9). Smoothing: Matern 3/2 Gaussian process, results unchanged for fixed length scales of 2, 4 and 8 degrees; 0.1-degree latitude bins. Combined density: core x smoothed drift likelihood (one-dimensional, along the arc); the per-point reweighting of the two-dimensional core samples gives a shift of the mean of +1.43 degrees (eight draw seeds +1.17 to +1.68) against +1.15 here. Core: end of flight, Davey model + fuel, log-on event only. Provisional physics.